

SECTION 1 — Quantitative investment baseline

Uploaded-document evidence: An analysis of the company's official financial and strategic disclosures provides a comprehensive baseline for understanding its operational scale, capital allocation, and technology-related investment intensity. The company reported flat year-over-year net sales of 34,329 million SEK for the 2025 fiscal year, compared to 34,170 million SEK in the prior year.¹ Organic sales increased by 1 percent, while structural changes from acquisitions contributed an additional 5 percent, which was entirely offset by a negative 6 percent impact from exchange rate fluctuations.¹ Despite these macroeconomic headwinds, the company achieved its highest recorded profitability levels, reporting an EBITA (excluding items affecting comparability) of 6,286 million SEK, representing a margin of 18.3 percent, up from 18.0 percent in 2024.¹ Total capital employed by the Group was reported at 44,972 million SEK at the close of 2025, a decrease from 49,381 million SEK in the prior year.¹

The company allocates substantial capital toward structural improvements, automation, and technological optimization within its manufacturing and operational footprint. The overall capital expenditure for the period decreased by 9 percent year-over-year, dropping from 1,883 million SEK in 2024 to 1,713 million SEK in 2025.¹ While the company does not explicitly isolate capital or operational expenditures dedicated exclusively to artificial intelligence, software, or data capabilities as standalone financial line items, its investments in digital and intellectual infrastructure are partially reflected in its intangible asset ledger. In 2025, gross capital expenditures for intangible assets—which the filing explicitly states includes capitalized expenditure for development work and IT—amounted to 104 million SEK, a reduction from 136 million SEK in 2024.¹ Amortization of intangible assets (excluding items affecting comparability) stood at 666 million SEK, representing a slight increase from 618 million SEK in 2024.¹ The carrying amount for capitalized expenditure was 307 million SEK at the end of 2025, down from 415 million SEK the previous year.¹

The company maintains an extensive global innovation infrastructure, officially operating 35 dedicated Research and Development (R&D) centers that support its engineering and manufacturing operations across approximately 40 countries.¹ The strategic focus on continuous improvement is formalized through a Group-wide "Excellence" program encompassing Manufacturing, Energy, Purchasing, Sales, and People.¹ Within this framework, the company explicitly identifies artificial intelligence and advanced data analytics as transformative drivers that enable significant streamlining of industrial processes.¹ The filings confirm that AI and automation are increasingly utilized within the business to optimize production, streamline administrative workflows, conduct predictive maintenance, and develop customized commercial offerings.¹ Notably, the company reports that the deepened integration of AI into its core processes has successfully reduced certain design cycles by up to 30 percent, thereby enabling faster go-to-market delivery for customers.¹

Acquisition activity serves as a primary mechanism for the company to integrate new technologies, software capabilities, and specialized engineering talent. In 2025, the company spent 1,312 million SEK on acquisitions, a significant reduction from the 5,496 million SEK spent in 2024.¹ The company completed six acquisitions during the year to broaden its portfolio in

high-growth segments.¹ These included the acquisition of CRC Distribution to expand specialist polymer sealing distribution in the United States; NuFlow, a North American manufacturer of specialized liners, resins, and robotic equipment for small-diameter pipe repair; National Gummi in Sweden for niche construction and automotive profiles; Aero-Plastics in the United States for high-performance aerospace plastics; Sico in Europe for silicone rubber products; and Masterseals in Singapore to strengthen its energy sector sealing solutions.¹

Public-source evidence: Interim and year-end financial disclosures provide a more precise accounting of the company's research and development intensity. According to the company's Q4 2025 year-end report, total research and development costs recognized in the income statement for the 12-month period in 2025 were 721 million SEK, representing a marginal increase from 710 million SEK in 2024.² Trade press and industry analysts report that the company's total R&D and engineering spending is estimated at roughly 1 billion SEK annually when including localized engineering expenses and supplier partnership investments that are not fully capitalized on the balance sheet.³

While the company does not disclose standalone IT software spending, AI cloud infrastructure costs, or digital platform revenues in its official financial statements, its investments in third-party vendor platforms are visible through official partner case studies. The company engages Sociabble for employee advocacy and corporate communication platforms, investing in generative AI tools to support content creation.⁴ Additionally, the company is actively migrating its enterprise content management infrastructure from legacy Lotus Notes systems to the M-Files platform.⁵ These transitions represent vendor-supported operational deployments requiring software licensing and cloud infrastructure expenditures, though the exact contract values and annual recurring costs are not publicly disclosed by either the company or its vendors.

Assessment:

The quantitative baseline indicates that the company is maintaining a steady, highly disciplined capital expenditure profile. The business is generating historically high profitability margins while slightly reducing its overall physical capital expenditures and capitalized IT expenditures. The reduction in capitalized IT and development expenditures from 415 million SEK to 307 million SEK, alongside the confirmed migration to third-party platforms like M-Files and Sociabble, suggests that the company is likely transitioning from a phase of heavy internal system building to a vendor-supported Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) model. In a SaaS model, technology costs shift from capitalized balance sheet assets (CapEx) to ongoing operating expenses (OpEx), which aligns with the observed financial trends.

The company does not disclose AI-specific, cloud-specific, software-specific, or data-specific spend as isolated financial line items. Therefore, exact investment intensity in artificial intelligence cannot be derived directly from the financial ledger. However, the presence of 35 global R&D centers, a dedicated annual R&D expense of 721 million SEK, and consistent acquisition spending of 1,312 million SEK demonstrates a strong, ongoing financial commitment to industrial innovation. The explicit confirmation in the annual report that AI has reduced design cycles by 30 percent provides direct proof that the company's digital investments are achieving measurable, operational returns on investment, transitioning from theoretical

exploration to scaled internal deployment.

SECTION 2 — Capability-by-capability analysis, including GenAI and agentic systems

Machine learning and computer vision for manufacturing quality inspection

Uploaded-document evidence: The uploaded hiring analysis indicates that the company is specifically targeting capabilities in machine learning and computer vision to support its manufacturing operations.¹ The stated objective of this capability building is to automate part counting and optimize production processes, thereby improving traceability and strict quality control on the factory floor.¹ The hiring data shows that these roles are situated within the Manufacturing Operations business area, indicating a direct application of algorithms to physical production environments rather than isolated IT research.¹

Public-source evidence: Public statements from Gordon Micallef, Business Unit President within the company's sealing solutions division, provide direct evidence of the operational mechanisms behind this capability.⁶ Micallef confirms that the company is actively utilizing artificial intelligence for automated inspection.⁶ He explains the specific engineering problem the company is solving: traditional automated inspection machinery relies on basic optical detection, identifying lighter or darker contrasts on the surface of a part to find defects.⁶ However, for highly complex sealing geometries and specialized polymer parts, these traditional optical detection methods are ineffective and yield false readings.⁶

To solve this, the company has developed and deployed computer vision systems that capture detailed images of manufactured parts and classify them as either compliant or defective.⁶ The machine learning models are continuously trained on various defect types and sizes, improving their recognition accuracy over time.⁶ Furthermore, the company leverages academic partnerships to build a talent pipeline for these capabilities. A project bank managed by the Sealing Solutions division in Helsingør, Denmark, lists active student projects focused on "Computer Vision & Automated Inspection".⁷ These projects explore open-source platforms and deep learning frameworks for real-time defect detection and object recognition, explicitly citing internal production initiatives labeled "Rod Vision" and "Vision Touch For Quality".⁷

Assessment:

The evidence supports the operational deployment of machine learning and computer vision for manufacturing quality inspection. The company is solving a highly specific, concrete manufacturing problem: traditional optical inspection is inadequate for the complex polymer geometries required in advanced sealing solutions. By training custom computer vision models to classify defects based on proprietary image data, the company reduces material waste, ensures part reliability for critical applications (such as aerospace or medical devices), and accelerates production throughput. The combination of executive confirmation describing near-industrialized projects and continuous talent pipelining in Denmark suggests that this capability is internally developed, owned, and applied directly to the factory floor, moving well beyond early-stage pilot activity.

AI-driven analytics and anomaly detection for product design and material selection

Uploaded-document evidence: The company's Annual Report explicitly states that the integration of artificial intelligence into core engineering processes has been deepened across the organization.¹ The document claims that this integration has successfully cut certain design

cycles by up to 30 percent, enabling significantly faster go-to-market timelines for customers.¹ The uploaded hiring dataset corroborates this focus on R&D acceleration, showing targeted investment signals in machine learning and unsupervised anomaly detection specifically tailored for seal life cycle testing.¹ The hiring report notes that this application is used to identify irregularities during the testing phase, further accelerating the product development cycle and improving the final quality of engineered materials.¹

Public-source evidence: Public evidence reveals the existence of a specific, internally developed AI capability known as the "Shim Wizard".⁶ This AI-based analysis tool is currently in active use by the company's design engineers.⁶ The Shim Wizard solves a complex combinatorial problem in material science: it recommends the optimal polymer compounds and physical properties required to maximize the performance of automotive brake shims, basing its recommendations on historical performance and simulated data.⁶

Additionally, the company has established a state-of-the-art Innovation Center that relies on a fully digitized development workflow.⁹ This workflow integrates 3D Computer-Aided Design (CAD), Finite Element Analysis (FEA), and Computational Fluid Dynamics (CFD) with 3D printing and rapid prototyping.⁹ The company also utilizes AI-based simulation in collaboration with customers and industry partners to develop highly specialized materials, such as a recently launched PFAS-free elastomer designed for the demanding conditions of the semiconductor industry.¹⁰

Assessment:

The evidence supports the scaled internal deployment of AI for material selection, formulation, and design simulation. The "Shim Wizard" is a confirmed operational tool solving a specific engineering bottleneck: formulating highly specialized polymer compounds for strict automotive constraints requires vast amounts of historical data analysis. Artificial intelligence expedites this by rapidly surfacing optimized compounds. The explicitly reported outcome—a 30 percent reduction in design cycles—indicates a highly mature capability that delivers measurable business impact. The presence of unsupervised anomaly detection for lifecycle testing further demonstrates that the company is building specialized, internal algorithms to process proprietary R&D data, securing a competitive advantage in material science speed-to-market.

Connected products and predictive maintenance via IoT and machine learning

Uploaded-document evidence: The Annual Report emphasizes the company's strategic focus on expanding its portfolio of connected services and sensor-enabled solutions.¹ The document explicitly notes that artificial intelligence creates significant opportunities for the company to work more extensively with predictive maintenance.¹ By analyzing data and understanding customer needs, the company aims to transition from selling passive components to offering customized, optimized, and connected solutions.¹

Public-source evidence: The company has launched a mature commercial capability branded as "Cognitive Sealing".¹¹ This service integrates artificial intelligence, neural networks, and Internet of Things (IoT) sensors directly into industrial sealing applications.¹¹ Johannes Kunze von Bischoffshausen, the company's Manager of Digital Transformation, explains the

operational mechanism: the system collects telemetry data from sensors installed around the hydraulic sealing environment and utilizes AI to calculate a continuous "health score" for the equipment.¹⁴

This capability solves a critical commercial problem for end-users: polymer seals are frequently the weakest link in high-pressure hydraulic systems, and unexpected failure results in catastrophic downtime and severe economic losses for heavy off-highway equipment or continuous industrial processing systems.¹⁴ To support this product line, the company has built a dedicated, cross-disciplinary team of highly skilled data scientists, electronic engineers, and sealing experts who collaborate directly with customers to develop predictive failure models and system health dashboards.¹²

Assessment:

The evidence supports the commercial deployment of AI-enabled predictive maintenance and IoT connectivity. "Cognitive Sealing" is not merely an internal efficiency mechanism; it is a direct, customer-facing product offering that generates value. By deploying neural networks to analyze sensor data and predict wear before a failure occurs, the company is successfully executing a strategic transition from a traditional manufacturer of consumable polymer parts to a provider of smart, digital services. The existence of a dedicated team of data scientists working on predictive failure models confirms strong internal ownership and a high level of production maturity for this capability.

Digital platforms for automated port infrastructure and vessel navigation

Uploaded-document evidence: The Annual Report notes that the company provides "services supported by digital tools to make life easier and increase value for its customers," highlighting ongoing investments and acquisitions intended to expand its footprint in marine and infrastructure solutions.¹ The report mentions the inauguration of a new production facility in Vietnam specifically to increase capacity for marine infrastructure-related polymer solutions.¹

Public-source evidence: The company has developed and commercially deployed a comprehensive suite of digital capabilities for marine infrastructure under its "SmartPort" platform.¹⁶ A flagship application within this ecosystem is AutoMoor, an automated, rope-free mooring system.¹⁶ AutoMoor solves the operational and safety hazards of manual maritime mooring by utilizing vacuum pad and passive damping technology powered by SmartPort connectivity.¹⁶ The system continuously monitors all mooring loads experienced by vessels at the berth and delivers real-time data to port operators, enabling the optimization of day-to-day terminal operations and reducing vessel turnaround times.¹⁶

Furthermore, the company offers SafePilot, an iOS-based professional piloting software utilized by marine pilots worldwide.¹⁸ SafePilot utilizes an intelligent software kernel for multi-layer chart handling, real-time vessel positioning, and predictive route modeling, integrating seamlessly with portable piloting units to provide AIS data.¹⁸ Trade publications indicate that broader data analytics in port management rely heavily on anomaly detection and traffic prediction tools, aligning perfectly with the data-rich ecosystem the company supports via its SmartPort integrations.²⁰

Assessment:

The evidence supports the commercial deployment of integrated digital platforms and IoT

systems for marine environments. The company is actively building, selling, and deploying physical-digital hybrid systems. AutoMoor and SafePilot solve the operational problems of maritime logistics inefficiency and port safety, replacing manual, high-risk mooring and navigation processes with data-driven, automated systems. This capability demonstrates robust internal ownership of digital product development geared toward heavy infrastructure, moving the company up the value chain in the maritime sector.

Generative AI for corporate communications and enterprise knowledge management
Uploaded-document evidence: The hiring analysis identifies investment signals categorized under "Enterprise AI Strategy and Platform Infrastructure".¹ This capability building indicates the establishment of enterprise-wide AI governance frameworks, Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) solutions, and generative AI (GenAI) capabilities aimed at solving cross-functional business challenges across manufacturing, operations, and sales.¹ The stated objective of these hires is to identify AI opportunities that accelerate digital transformation, enable intelligent automation, and drive optimized decision-making.¹

Public-source evidence: The company utilizes the Sociabble platform to manage its employee advocacy and corporate communications.⁴ This vendor platform includes an integrated generative AI feature called "Ask AI".⁴ The company's employees and engineers use Ask AI to rephrase, translate, and simplify highly complex technical messages into accessible content for social selling and brand ambassadorship.⁴ A Project Manager within the company noted that this GenAI tool effectively removes writing barriers, particularly for non-native speakers, resulting in hundreds of internal uses and the generation of 2,599 pieces of content within a single year.⁴

Additionally, the company is overhauling its internal enterprise content management by migrating away from a fragmented Lotus Notes environment to the M-Files platform.⁵ M-Files is currently deployed to manage engineering projects, sample requests, quality management workflows, and customer approvals.⁵ In conjunction with this migration, the company is exploring M-Files' generative AI capability, known as "Aino," alongside semantic indexing and Microsoft Copilot.⁵ The strategic objective is to leverage Large Language Models (LLMs) to extract deeper insights across the company's vast repositories of structured business data.⁵ However, company representatives explicitly state that this deeper GenAI integration is "not yet in full use," characterizing it as an early investigation signaling long-term plans.⁵

Assessment:

The evidence supports the vendor-supported operational deployment of Generative AI for corporate communications, and pilot activity/exploration for GenAI in enterprise knowledge management. The company is not attempting to build its own foundational LLMs or proprietary agentic systems from scratch. Instead, it is solving workflow friction—such as the difficulty engineers face when translating technical data into marketing content, and the siloing of legacy project data—by buying and integrating mature vendor platforms (Sociabble, M-Files, Microsoft). The Sociabble GenAI deployment has achieved measurable business impact in content generation volume. Meanwhile, the M-Files GenAI integration remains an exploratory capability building effort, confirming that the company has vendor-mediated exposure to GenAI rather than internal ownership of the underlying AI architecture.

Industrial robotics and automated manufacturing systems

Uploaded-document evidence: The Annual Report explicitly notes that automation remains a highly prominent structural trend across global industry, significantly fueling demand for the company's solutions.¹ The report also confirms that the company is actively utilizing both automation and artificial intelligence within its own business operations to streamline production and optimize administrative efficiency.¹

Public-source evidence: The company leverages advanced robotic capabilities in its trenchless pipe rehabilitation business segment. It actively markets and deploys the PowerCUTTER 200 E, which is described as an advanced, high-performance milling robot featuring an electric motor.²¹ This robot is designed for precise and efficient pipe rehabilitation in highly demanding environments.²¹ It is deployed directly into subterranean infrastructure to repair pipes without the need for disruptive and costly surface excavation.²¹

Furthermore, within its own operational footprint, the company recently introduced fully automated manufacturing cells designed specifically for the production of complex rubber-metal components.¹⁰ The deployment of these automated cells has directly increased the company's manufacturing competitiveness by optimizing precision and significantly reducing the physical space required for production lines.¹⁰

Assessment:

The evidence supports both the commercial deployment of robotic products (the PowerCUTTER series) and the scaled internal deployment of factory automation (automated manufacturing cells). The company solves critical engineering and logistical problems by eliminating the need for trench digging in municipal pipe repair, providing a highly efficient robotic alternative. Internally, the company optimizes its floor space and unit economics through automated cells. This capability relies heavily on advanced electro-mechanical engineering fused with automated control software, demonstrating a strong, mature integration of digital and physical operational technologies.

SECTION 3 — Talent, teams, and operating model

Uploaded-document evidence: The uploaded hiring dataset, which establishes a baseline of 2,048 observed job postings, reveals a highly targeted, though low-volume, signal for AI capabilities.¹ Within this dataset, only 5 postings are categorized as "AI-core," with an additional 17 identified as "AI-adjacent".¹ The timeline of these postings illustrates a nascent but growing focus on capability building: zero AI-core roles were observed in 2023, one in 2024, two in 2025, and two observed for 2026.¹ Geographically, the broader hiring dataset indicates a high general volume of recruitment in the United States (810 postings), Great Britain (264), Germany (193), and India (185).¹ However, the specific AI-core roles are geographically concentrated exclusively in the United States, Germany, and Denmark.¹

Organizationally, the uploaded hiring evidence points to a cross-functional distribution of technical talent. Out of the 5 AI-core postings, 3 sit within IT and Data, 1 is located in Manufacturing Operations, and 1 is situated in Materials Research.¹ The seniority mix for these specific AI roles includes 3 mid-level and 2 senior-level positions.¹ The uploaded hiring dataset does not show evidence of mass hiring of entry-level software engineers or large-scale AI

development teams.

Public-source evidence: Public evidence provides vital context for understanding the company's digital operating model and team structure. Around 2017, the company's Sealing Solutions business area established centralized "Digital Transformation" and "IoT" teams to govern process management, information systems, and new technological explorations.⁶ This central function collaborates directly with decentralized local manufacturing sites and R&D facilities. For example, to develop the commercial "Cognitive Sealing" capability, the company assembled a cross-disciplinary team comprising highly skilled data scientists, electronic engineers, and polymer sealing experts.¹²

The company also actively utilizes academic partnerships to build a sustainable talent pipeline for emerging technologies. The Sealing Solutions facility in Helsingør, Denmark, runs a dedicated "Project Bank" for university students, explicitly recruiting interns and master's thesis students from data science, computer science, and engineering disciplines.⁷ These students are tasked with developing and testing machine learning models for anomaly detection, deploying computer vision for defect detection, and building data pipelines for manufacturing insights.⁷

Assessment:

The combined evidence supports a hybrid operating model that blends centralized digital governance with decentralized, domain-specific execution. The company relies on centralized centers of excellence (such as the Digital Transformation and IoT teams) working in tandem with local engineering facilities (such as the operations in Denmark). The hiring data confirms that the company is not attempting to become a standalone software vendor; the extremely low volume of AI-core postings indicates a strategy focused on niche capability building rather than massive internal software development.

The concentration of AI roles in IT, Manufacturing, and Materials Research perfectly aligns with the company's publicly confirmed deployed applications: enterprise data platforms, computer vision on the factory floor, and AI simulation for polymer formulation. The seniority mix—favoring mid-to-senior level practitioners—suggests the company is hiring experienced architects to lead these implementations. Concurrently, the utilization of student projects in Denmark suggests a highly pragmatic, cost-effective approach to exploring early-stage computer vision and data analytics models before committing to full-time permanent headcount. This operating model ensures that digital capabilities are tightly integrated with the company's core material science and manufacturing expertise.

SECTION 4 — What the evidence implies for investment priorities and competitor monitoring

Priority 1: Accelerating product development and material formulation via AI simulation

Evidence base: Uploaded annual report statements confirming a 30 percent reduction in design cycles¹; uploaded hiring signals for anomaly detection in product lifecycle testing¹; public evidence detailing the "Shim Wizard" formulation tool and the Innovation Center's fully digital development workflows.⁶ What the company is trying to achieve: The company aims to drastically shorten the time required to engineer, test, and manufacture highly complex polymer components. By using artificial intelligence to parse vast amounts of historical testing data and simulate material properties digitally, the company seeks to bypass the traditional,

slow, and expensive iteration loops of physical prototyping. What is known: The company has successfully developed and deployed AI tools (like the Shim Wizard) to recommend material formulations and has integrated computational fluid dynamics and finite element analysis seamlessly into its standard design workflow. What remains uncertain: It is currently unclear to what extent these AI-driven simulation tools are rolled out globally across all distinct business units versus being localized specifically to high-margin divisions, such as Sealing Solutions and automotive brake shims. Competitor implication: Competitors in the engineered polymers and industrial component space must closely monitor this acceleration in speed-to-market. A confirmed 30 percent reduction in design cycles provides the company with a significant commercial moat, allowing it to respond to custom OEM requests faster and with lower R&D overhead than legacy competitors. Competitors lacking AI-driven simulation and material formulation capabilities risk being outpaced in bidding for complex, bespoke industrial contracts, particularly in fast-moving sectors like electric vehicles and semiconductors.

Priority 2: Transitioning from passive components to smart, sensor-enabled digital services

Evidence base: Annual report references prioritizing connected services and predictive maintenance¹; public evidence detailing the "Cognitive Sealing" product line, IoT integration, and the SmartPort/AutoMoor maritime platforms.¹² What the company is trying to achieve: The company is fundamentally shifting its value proposition from selling a easily commoditized physical component (such as a rubber seal or a marine fender) to selling ongoing operational reliability and guaranteed uptime. By integrating sensors and analyzing telemetry with neural networks, the company aims to embed itself deeply into the customer's operational technology stack, generating long-term loyalty and potential recurring service revenue through continuous condition monitoring. What is known: The Cognitive Sealing and SmartPort concepts are actively marketed, commercially deployed products. The company has dedicated specialized teams of data scientists and electronic engineers to support the continuous development of these hybrid physical-digital systems. What remains uncertain: The evidence does not publicly disclose the current adoption rate or the revenue share of these connected products relative to the company's traditional passive components. Furthermore, the exact monetization model (e.g., whether value is captured through a hardware mark-up or an ongoing software-as-a-service subscription fee) remains uncertain. Competitor implication: Industrial component manufacturers must recognize that the basis of competition in their sector is shifting rapidly. If a market leader can guarantee equipment uptime through AI-driven predictive maintenance, buyers will increasingly view non-connected competitor products as unacceptable operational risks. Competitors will likely be forced to develop their own IoT architectures and data analytics partnerships rapidly to achieve technological parity and defend their market share.

Priority 3: Enhancing operational efficiency and quality control via factory automation

Evidence base: Hiring signals targeting computer vision and machine learning for manufacturing environments¹; public evidence of camera-based automated defect inspection and the rollout of fully automated manufacturing cells for rubber-metal components.⁶ What the company is trying to achieve: The company intends to relentlessly lower unit costs, reduce material scrap rates, and optimize the physical floor space of its factories. By automating visual quality

assurance for complex geometries that traditional optical sensors frequently misclassify, the company ensures higher product yield and strict compliance for demanding, low-tolerance sectors like aerospace and semiconductor manufacturing. What is known: Machine learning models are actively being trained to classify parts as compliant or defective using proprietary image data. Simultaneously, automated manufacturing cells are being physically deployed to streamline the production of complex components. What remains uncertain: It is not publicly detailed what percentage of the company's global footprint of over 100 manufacturing sites has fully integrated these advanced AI inspection systems, nor the exact capital expenditure required to retrofit legacy plants with this computer vision technology. Competitor implication: Competitors should expect this company to maintain strong margin resilience, even in highly inflationary environments or tight labor markets. Because automated inspection and manufacturing cells drastically reduce reliance on manual labor and limit costly production errors, the company can sustain profitability and potentially underprice competitors who still rely on manual quality control or legacy optical sorting.

Priority 4: Modernizing enterprise knowledge management and back-office productivity

Evidence base: Hiring signals for Enterprise AI Strategy¹; public evidence confirming the transition to M-Files for content management, the exploration of Microsoft Copilot and Aino, and the active use of Sociabble's "Ask AI" for corporate communications.⁴ What the company is trying to achieve: The company is actively eliminating fragmented legacy information silos (such as Lotus Notes) to create a unified, structured data environment. By exploring Generative AI and semantic indexing, the company seeks to unlock decades of institutional knowledge, enabling engineers and administrative staff to retrieve project data instantly and communicate complex technical expertise externally without workflow friction. What is known: The company is actively migrating to the M-Files platform and is utilizing vendor-provided GenAI tools (like Ask AI) to successfully generate thousands of pieces of internal and external communication. What remains uncertain: The integration of Large Language Models with the company's proprietary structured data (often referred to as Retrieval-Augmented Generation or RAG architecture) is still explicitly described as being in the exploratory phase. The timeline for full operational deployment of these capabilities across all engineering teams is not established. Competitor implication: While this is largely an internal operational efficiency play, the successful deployment of enterprise-wide GenAI knowledge retrieval allows engineering, procurement, and sales teams to operate with substantially greater agility. Competitors bogged down by fragmented legacy IT systems will continue to operate with higher administrative overhead and slower internal decision-making compared to a digitally modernized competitor capable of leveraging its entire historical database instantaneously.

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